

An Appeal to the United Nations

A declaration by ordinary people

We, ordinary people¹, make the following declaration concerning the conduct of the State of Israel towards the State of Palestine, other states in the Middle East and the Rule of Law, while gathered in assembly in The Hague, City of Peace and Justice, The Netherlands, on August 28, 2026. The declaration is directed to the United Nations, using the good offices of its Secretary-General, Mr. A.M. de Oliveira Guterres.

1. In this declaration we, ordinary people, bring forward a social demand for justice concerning the disruptive conduct of the State of Israel in the Middle East. It is carried by people from across the world. In this we call for respect of values and the Rule of Law, as many common citizens would like to express. We, ordinary people, do not profess expertise but we try nonetheless to use some precise language to explain what upsets us. The multitude of expressions of violence by the State of Israel and the absence of respect for the Rule of Law in the territories it occupied in 1967 and beyond, are hurtful in many ways and they are at the centre of this Appeal to the United Nations. In this plea no argument is advanced to deny the State of Israel its sovereign foundation. On the contrary, in respect of that foundation, it is in this Appeal explained why misbehaviour by the State of Israel is not acceptable for us, ordinary people. The demand that we promote is specified at the end of this Appeal.

The void

2. We, ordinary people, affirm that we regard the Rule of Law, and the inherent respect for international law, as central to the spirit in which modern post-Second World War governments must conduct their administrations. We further

¹ The phrase 'ordinary people' refers in this Appeal to the ever-changing group of individuals who take an interest in international developments. Their common denominator is that they follow international events through various sources and discuss international news with others. They do not claim to possess particular expertise, but they do have views on what is unacceptable when a state exercises its power. People who do not ordinarily take an interest in developments beyond the borders of the country in which they live, but who nevertheless make the effort to take note of this unusual Appeal, are also considered to fall within our definition of 'ordinary people'. This ever-changing group of individuals observing 'state behaviour' may also be associated with the phrase 'The world is actively watching': the undefined body of ordinary people who are regularly stunned by the many extreme failures of international politics.

acknowledge that in the illegally occupied territories² of the State of Palestine³ by the State of Israel, the Rule of Law is absent; that this ongoing situation has been brought about by the actions of the State of Israel which does not exonerate non-state parties such as Hamas; that Palestinians endure the grave consequences of this void; and that we therefore take the liberty through you, Mr. Secretary-General, of making a direct appeal to the United Nations to take collective and corrective action regarding the State of Israel.

Nature of Request

3. The permanent defence posture of the State of Israel has, at various moments, been widely perceived as necessary⁴. It has, however, developed into an offensive approach⁵ aimed at the destruction of an entire people and its state. This is unacceptable in any form. This Appeal urges the United Nations to take measures to rein in the State of Israel.
4. We, ordinary people, acknowledge that the observations and conclusions set out here centre on the absence of the Rule of Law in the occupied territories⁶ under the control of the State of Israel. Our declaration focusses on the dramatic and inhumane consequences of this absence of the Rule of Law for the Palestinian people in the occupied territories, and that this situation has become emblematic of what can occur when a state fails to uphold the Rule of Law.
5. We, ordinary people, affirm that our focus on the occupied territories does not absolve other states that fail to respect the Rule of Law. Rather, the horrific situation of the population of Palestine has become a deplorable example for the complete erosion of viable prospects for a dignified life when states do not abide by the Rule of Law.

² With the phrase ‘illegally occupied territories’ reference is made to the in 1967 illegally occupied territories by the State of Israel, meaning the territories that were designated to become part of the State of Palestine as envisioned in the 1947 Partition Plan of the United Nations and that were governed between 1949 and 1967 by Jordan and Egypt. These territories are hereafter also referred to as ‘occupied territories’.

³ The ‘State of Palestine’, as endorsed in 1988 by the UN National General Assembly, is hereafter also referred to as ‘Palestine’. The status of the State of Palestine was more directly endorsed by the United Nations in 2012 when Palestine became a ‘non-member observer State’ of the United Nations. Meanwhile it is noted that the State of Palestine has been recognized by 157 states from a total of 193 UN member states.

⁴ It should be noted that this perception was never universally shared. From the outset, most Palestinians, other Arabs and many non-Arabs regarded the establishment of the State of Israel in 1948 as an injustice imposed on the Palestinians through international politics. Palestinians experienced widespread dispossession and displacement, collectively known as the Nakba, or “the catastrophe.”

⁵ The shades of the term ‘defensive’ are fluent as fighting began immediately after the UN adopted the Partition Plan in 1947. Palestinian displacement started soon afterwards, with refugees arriving in neighbouring countries by late 1947.

⁶ Reference is made to the territories ‘occupied’ by the State of Israel through the 1967 Arab – Israeli war.

Territories in question

6. Israel did not define its borders when it declared its independence on 14 May 1948. The Declaration of Independence referred to the UN Partition Plan of 1947, but it did not adopt the boundaries proposed in that plan. The 1949 armistice lines marked where the opposing forces stood after the war. The armistice agreements expressly stated that these lines were not final political or territorial borders. Israel subsequently established internationally agreed borders with Egypt and Jordan through peace treaties, but not all its borders have ever been definitively settled.⁷
7. We, ordinary people, acknowledge that, for the purposes of this Appeal and Request to the United Nations, we refer to Palestine as the State of Palestine, encompassing the West Bank, including East Jerusalem, and the Gaza Strip, collectively known as the Palestinian territories occupied by Israel after the war of 1967.
8. We, ordinary people, further acknowledge that the United Nations recognised the State of Israel by establishing its full membership in 1949⁸.

Expulsions

9. We, ordinary people, acknowledge that large numbers of Palestinian inhabitants of the territory that now comprises the State of Israel have been forced to leave that territory between 1947 and 1949 and after 1967. We recognise that further expulsions, as well as various forms of pressure on the Palestinians to depart, have occurred through a multitude of actions by the State of Israel and its nationals. We further acknowledge that Palestinians have been expelled to areas that are indeed part of Palestine – namely Gaza and the West Bank – but also to other areas in Lebanon, Syria and Jordan and other countries, and that this process of expulsion by the State of Israel has, over the years, been accompanied by the detention and imprisonment of Palestinians as in Israeli camps and prisons. We note that these detentions have involved a staggering

⁷ The UN Partition Plan was rejected by the principal Palestinian Arab leadership and the Arab states at the time (1948) and it was never implemented. Regular Arab armies entered former Mandatory Palestine mainly after the end of the British Mandate (14 May 1947) and the moment of the proclamation of Israel's Declaration of Independence, although actual fighting and the entry of Arab irregulars had begun earlier. Their principal positions were in territory proposed for the Arab state, but they also attacked areas proposed for the Jewish state, while Transjordan occupied East Jerusalem, which the UN Plan had designated for international administration. By the 1949 armistices, Israel controlled approximately 78% of Palestine, rather than the roughly 56% envisaged in the Partition Plan.

⁸ The State of Israel was accepted on 11 May 1949 to the United Nations via the United Nations General Assembly Resolution 273.

number of Palestinian detainees, and that large numbers of those arrested or detained have subsequently been reported as missing.

10. We, ordinary people, acknowledge that the events described above have given rise to violent responses that constitute grave misconduct, including murder and mass killing, also on the Palestinian side. We further recognise that the near-continuous succession of violent incidents over a period of more than seventy years is unacceptable.

Acts of genocide and crimes of war

11. We, ordinary people, acknowledge that the State of Israel has, up to this date (mid-2026), executed an almost uninterrupted series of acts understood by us, ordinary people, to constitute acts of genocide⁹ and war crimes in response to the heinous attack on Israel by the Gaza-based Islamist movement Hamas, and affiliated groups with similar objectives, on 7 October 2023¹⁰. We further acknowledge that these acts of genocide and war crimes by the State of Israel have caused a large number of civilian casualties; that these operations have led to the widespread total destruction of civilian life and infrastructure in Gaza and,

⁹ Reference is made to Article II of the *1948 Convention on the Prevention and Punishment of the Crime of Genocide*, which defines genocide as specified acts — including killing and deliberately inflicting conditions of life calculated to bring about a group's physical destruction — committed with the intent to destroy, in whole or in part, a national, ethnic, racial or religious group.

Our position differs from that of those who maintain that, in the absence of a final judicial ruling, it is not yet possible to conclude that genocide has been committed by the State of Israel. Such an absence does not, however, require ordinary people to suspend their judgment or remain silent when an abundance of information from trustworthy sources supports their view. In the face of the overwhelming and extensively documented evidence since October 2023 — including information about mass killing and injury, the destruction of homes and essential civilian infrastructure, repeated forcible displacement, and the deprivation of food, water, shelter and medical care — we cannot remain silent.

The incriminating statements made by senior Israeli political and military figures concerning the deliberate destruction of Gaza and the Palestinian population are telling. For us, there is no doubt as to the genocidal nature of this conduct. We are not alone in reaching that conclusion.

The *UN Independent International Commission of Inquiry* concluded in September 2025 that Israel had committed genocide against Palestinians in Gaza, including acts falling within Article II(a)–(d) of the Convention. The *International Association of Genocide Scholars* has likewise concluded that Israel's policies and actions in Gaza meet the legal definition of genocide. See also [Middle East Eye](#).

Israel's conduct in the West Bank must be addressed separately, but it cannot be viewed in isolation. Killings, settler violence, demolitions, systematic dispossession, forcible displacement, illegal settlement expansion, discriminatory planning policies, persecution and measures aimed at annexation form part of the wider assault on the Palestinian people. They are also relevant to our assessment of the broader pattern and intent underlying Israeli state policy.

Israel's organised and unrestrained violence in other countries in the Middle East can and must likewise be judged under international law. It demonstrates the wider regional extent of Israel's violent state conduct. The need for legal proceedings, and the time required for courts to reach their decisions, will not prevent us from making this Appeal to the United Nations.

¹⁰ This Appeal has its focus on 'state behaviour' and not on behaviour of individuals, groups or organisations with a private nature. The horrific mass killing that took place on 7 October 2023 is therefore outside the scope of this address to the United Nations.

in part, to the destruction of the West Bank; to the further occupation of Gaza, the West Bank and areas of Lebanon and Syria by the State of Israel; and to massive destruction in South Lebanon and its capital. We note that the level of destruction by the State of Israel has, apart from the acts of genocide and war crimes, been characterized in terms of ethnic cleansing, ethnocide, memocide, bibliocide and sociocide, and more. Can it be worse?

12. We, ordinary people, acknowledge that the member states of the United Nations have failed to rein in the bold and brutal abuse of power of the State of Israel that was originally recognised by the United Nations in 1949. We acknowledge that the indiscriminate violence visited upon the populations of Gaza, the West Bank, South Lebanon, Syria, Iran and other countries constitute, in our view, an unbroken series of war crimes and acts of genocide that is plainly visible to us.
13. We, ordinary people, acknowledge that the United Nations has the mission to promote the well-being of the people of its member states, and that this mission is set out in the purpose of the United Nations, which include, in particular – though not exclusively – the maintenance of international peace and security, the protection of human rights, delivery humanitarian assistance and the upholding of international law.
14. We, ordinary people, affirm that committing acts of genocide and war crimes runs directly counter to the purpose of the United Nations. In view of this, we consider that the State of Israel must be restrained by the United Nations. Regarding this point we note that for civilians it is generally a given that any activity that runs counter to the very objectives for which a license has been granted to them may lead to the revocation or partial withdrawal of those rights. We do not delve into reasons behind the double standards that are seen in the state-related case in which Israel is acting counter to the objectives of the United Nations. Nonetheless, we do ask the United Nations to take corrective action on a state that it supported into nationhood by accepting its full membership, while that state undertakes actions that constitute acts of genocide and war crimes. If not, what must we think of the United Nations? No correction undermines the credibility of the United Nations in an existential way.
15. We, ordinary people, further acknowledge that it cannot be an objective of the United Nations to facilitate or show lenience towards acts of genocide and war crimes perpetrated by any state over which the United Nations once conferred recognition, including the State of Israel, by virtue of the unique discretionary powers that the United Nations alone exercise under international public law. On the contrary, the opposite should apply. We, ordinary people, therefore,

understand that within this rationale the suspension of certain powers flowing from that sovereignty would be the normal step to take.

The Rule of Law at the core

16. We, ordinary people, acknowledge that rules of international public law form the legal basis for the establishment of the State of Israel. We further acknowledge that no authority other than founded on international public law can replace the international order that states accepted after the Second World War, and that respect for international law is one essential component of the principle of the Rule of Law, which ordinary people regard as the central pillar of modern governance.

17. We, ordinary people, acknowledge that the Rule of Law consists, in essence, of the following elements:

1. The State – also referred to as “the administration” – must adhere to the law, just as civilians are bound by the law;
2. The State must comply with rulings handed down by judges;
3. The State must honour commitments made by its representatives before a court or any other body charged with the resolution of disputes;
4. The State must respect human rights;
5. The State must fulfil obligations arising from treaties with other states and international organisations, including obligations relating to the law of armed conflict and to treaty observance (‘pacta sunt servanda’), and must act in a spirit of encouraging its treaty partners to do the same;
6. The State must ensure the separation of powers, in particular between the legislative, executive and judicial branches;
7. The State must put in place, and safeguard, meaningful and regular mechanisms for supervision and accountability of authorities acting on behalf of the State and of entities receiving public funds.

18. We, ordinary people, know that the above listed elements are the result of centuries of long and bitter conflicts between states, ethnic groups and/or other organised entities and that these elements have been carved out as the best possible way forward to progress as societies in a peaceful manner, both within themselves and in cooperation with other actors (states, groups, entities). We are therefore aware that the Rule of Law lies at the heart of modern statecraft and that this set of critical elements cannot be brushed aside or overruled by transactional arrangements -whether it be with commercial objectives or not- between those who have been entrusted with state power. We also understand in this way that we are not ruled by men but by laws and that no transaction of whatever nature and between whatever person or authority can override the above-mentioned legal principles of the Rule of Law.

Rule of Law and due process

19. We, ordinary people, affirm that the right of self-determination for the Palestinian people is infringed upon by the illegal occupation of territories of Palestine by the State of Israel, as is the ability of the Palestinian people to express their identity and security through control of their territorial homeland. We maintain that if this ongoing invasion and infringement by the State of Israel on the sovereign territory and powers of Palestine, and its inherent right of self-determination, is the outcome of obscured transactions by the State of Israel or by its leading politicians, officers or managers with other foreign state powers, their representatives or individuals, such arrangements or deals will not hold as the Rule of Law dictates that due processes should be adhered to.
20. We, ordinary people, hold that the sovereignty of a state cannot be traded in whatever shape or form. We understand that this is so because the sovereignty of a state cannot be owned or held by any private person, entity or other party. We acknowledge that according to standards set after the Second World War the fate of a state's sovereign status lies, in essence, with the people of that state. We, ordinary people, therefore affirm that the sovereignty of a state is in the hands of its citizens and not under the control of anyone particular or anything else. We stress that due process is the key to unlock the will of the people and that the Rule of Law is at the centre of this process.
21. We recognise that the consultation of a people about the continuation or the alteration of the sovereignty of the state to which they belong to hinges, by default, on providing the members of the people in question a fair chance to cast their vote on this vital matter and to do so according to appropriate legal protocols and safeguards. In addition, rules of international public law will apply while formal statements by states and international public authorities remain relevant for this existential matter of any state. Meanwhile, there is no short cut in this regard for consulting the people about the future of a state. The prerogative of changing sovereign powers lies in the hands of the people. This is their privilege and seen in historical perspective, it marks a major social achievement that we, ordinary people, recognise and embrace. We cannot accept "politicide", as one Israeli historian expressed the process. In this we are referring to a process designed to eliminate Palestinian political existence.
22. We emphasise this point because decades of history suggest that the State of Israel continues to attempt to alter, disrupt or undercut the sovereign rights of the State of Palestine, even though this ongoing and irregular effort is, in whatever shape or form, bound to fail. We recall, in this regard, that any lawful change in sovereign power is impossible without due process and that this legal situation arises from the very nature of a state's sovereignty, which simply cannot be owned, held, or traded by exclusive parties or persons, nor can it be confiscated through force of whatever kind. As for the nowadays appearing illusion to nonetheless acquire, buy or hold in some way sovereign rights 'as a private party' by striking a deal with occupying state forces, their representatives or Israeli

individuals, we note that this observation relates to apparent plans to redesign the now obliterated Gaza-strip into a commercial real estate success story. In this regard one may nowadays think about overseas business ventures, business alliances, foreign agents or individuals with great wealth who seek to extend their influence, ownership and profit potential through the seizure of state power – or elements thereof - and, in this way, lay their hands on parts of the occupied territories. Such forces will, however, bypass the view of the people of Palestine and therefore have no more validity than brutal force.

23. We reject in the strongest possible terms the yearslong campaign by the State of Israel to subjugate the will of the people of Palestine through acts that we believe to constitute acts of genocide, war crimes, continuous intimidation and oppressive measures such as detention and infringements of civilian life, contrary to the Rule of Law.

The road to extreme misconduct by the State of Israel

24. We, ordinary people, consider that in the occupied territories the State of Israel does not fulfil any of the core elements of the Rule of Law. We hold that these elements lie at the heart of a rules-based state that operates in the interests of the people it represents, or in its responsibility toward an occupied people, where the State of Israel has imposed a destructive path for the people in the occupied territories. Instead of upholding the standards of the Rule of Law, the State of Israel has become a state engaged in operations which we observe to be genocide, war crimes, curtailing of the press and media services, and violence against civilians, while maintaining practices of invasion of privacy and infringement of collective and personal safety by its army, police and officials. The disallowance or corruption of humanitarian aid in the illegally occupied territories, contrary to international conventions, has been a particularly cynical policy of Israel with dramatic effect on the Palestinian population that will last generations, and on their ability to rebuild their future.

Request for redesign of United Nations and the State of Israel

25. We, ordinary people, hold it to be self-evident that such prolonged and extreme misconduct by the State of Israel is equivalent to the conduct of a terror state¹¹, and that this has - in effect - been tolerated by the international community that brought the State of Israel into being in 1949 by endorsement of the United Nations, in addition to the endorsements and support by many individual member states of the United Nations.

26. While there has been repeated criticism by other states and organisations of the international community about the continued misconduct of the State of Israel,

¹¹ The phrase 'terror state' as outlined refers to a state that systematically responds in an excessive way to civilians under its rule, be it through excessive physical force by state officials or state supported groups or individuals, excessive armed intimidation or through excessive non-physical pressure through speech or tone or through excessive behaviour by state officers, police or army personnel.

effective measures to address this criticism have rarely been taken by that state, so we believe, and hence the acts of genocide and other infringements of international law continue. In addition, the response to that evasive behaviour by the State of Israel has been received by other states and the international community as if it this phenomenon of evasiveness and ongoing denial of the criminal behaviour by the State of Israel is like ‘a ship passing in the night’. That is how we have come to perceive it. But there is no reason for being complacent about all this, not as a matter of principle and not in terms of pragmatism. Due to the ongoing absence or shortage of corrective measures to redress the mentioned misconduct by the State of Israel the credibility of the current international framework at large is also at stake.

27. We acknowledge that the absence of effective corrective action by the international community in relation to a state whose creation was also endorsed by the United Nations demonstrates a profound incapacity on the part of that community, despite notable efforts to do better¹². We affirm that this incapacity is unacceptable to the people of Palestine and to us, ordinary people. We witness daily the unfolding of the horrific fate of the people of Palestine through media outlets and other reporting. We, ordinary people, insist therefore that such a massive and long-standing failure of guidance by the United Nations and, more broadly, by the diplomatic community over more than seventy years must unavoidably lead to a thorough redesign of both the United Nations and the State of Israel.

Extent of suffering in geographical terms

28. We, ordinary people, maintain that the evolution of the State of Israel into a state that repeatedly disregards binding obligations under international law, including international human rights law, is unacceptable in any form and degree. We further acknowledge that the framework of intended safeguards established in

¹² As for a recent initiative to bring the prospect of peace in the Middle East closer, reference is made to the civil society initiative ‘**Paris Call**’ (<https://parispeaceforum.org/publications/the-paris-call-for-the-two-state-solution/>).

The **Gaza Peace Plan** (November 17, 2025) did not involve the State of Palestine, a fundamental flaw in its conception and application. Recent initiatives were as follows:

1. **Global Alliance for the Implementation of the Two-State Solution** (launched in 2024, with Norway, Saudi Arabia and others playing leading roles). This created a diplomatic framework for coordinated action;
2. **The France–Saudi Arabia UN Conference** (July 2025), which produced the so-called "New York Declaration." This went further than the Paris Call by proposing concrete and time-bound steps toward Palestinian statehood, governance reform, Gaza reconstruction, and international follow-up mechanisms;
3. **The Paris Call for the Two-State Solution** (June 2025), bringing together hundreds of Israeli and Palestinian civil society leaders, peace organizations, academics, former officials, and international supporters. The Call urged a ceasefire, humanitarian access, hostage release, Palestinian statehood, and implementation of a two-state framework.;
4. **Follow-up meetings in 2026**, including another Paris gathering of Israeli and Palestinian civil society representatives that issued a "Call for Action" to the G7, emphasizing that settlement expansion, settler violence, and de facto annexation threaten the viability of a Palestinian state.

international law to enable corrective action by international organisations and their member states has, in practice, failed to operate in a timely and effective manner for the ordinary people of Palestine. This has also had a destabilising and destructive impact on millions of other people in neighbouring countries such as Lebanon, Syria and Jordan, with many years of intolerable suffering for the people in question.

Action required by the United Nations

29. We, ordinary people, acknowledge that the observed conduct of the State of Israel as it disregards the Rule of Law, including binding obligations under international law, requires curtailing its full member status of the United Nations. We affirm that the authority to withdraw or suspend rights of membership rests solely with the United Nations. We, ordinary people, desire nonetheless that the unrestrained behaviour of the State of Israel cease immediately. Its current conduct leads to the negation of the Rule of Law for which it is responsible in its application in the occupied territories, including the respect for international law, and we therefore call upon the United Nations to take all necessary measures to suspend the membership in the United Nations of the State of Israel that it accepted as a full member in 1949, limiting it to observer status.

Cause for limitation of status

30. We, ordinary people, acknowledge the reasons – in particular those arising from historical antisemitism and the Holocaust during the Second World War – for creating a safe haven, the State of Israel. We affirm on the other hand, that a ground for limiting the institutional powers of a state initially supported under United Nations auspices arises where that state has transformed itself into a state that disregards the Rule of Law, including binding obligations under international law, and, instead, behaves as a predatory and terror state.

31. We acknowledge that a license to exist as a sovereign state, as endorsed by the United Nations, does not and cannot include a license to commit acts of genocide and war crimes. On the contrary, we affirm these acts justify the redefinition of rights, including suspension of the rights and privileges in its relation to the United Nations. While Israel as an occupying power has legal responsibilities towards the population of Palestine, it has no mandate over the intrinsic sovereignty of Palestine.

32. We, ordinary people, acknowledge that the ability, in principle, to reset the course of a state's development follows from both internal (sovereign) and external forces (the international community¹³). In view of the ongoing misbehaviour by the State of Israel the international community is underperforming in its

¹³ The case of East Timor is a precedent for supporting self-determination and human rights, underscoring the principle that while state sovereignty remains fundamental to international law, it can be ethically challenged by international responsibility to protect populations experiencing systemic abuses.

responses. We regard this as unacceptable. The United Nations must take corrective and effective action against the State of Israel.

Resolution 242 and the ending of occupations

33. We, ordinary people, acknowledge that, if the State of Israel is, despite its abusive conduct, still maintained unchallenged by the United Nations for reasons that may relate to practicability, alignments of personal or group interest, or to political considerations beyond our view, it is essential that the State of Israel – as one of the few states created with United Nations involvement – in any case conform to the standards of the Rule of Law as listed above and to the rulings of the International Court of Justice (ICJ). We affirm that, to this end, the occupation by the State of Israel of Gaza, East Jerusalem, the West Bank and parts of Lebanon and Syria must be brought to a complete and immediate end. In this regard, we recall paragraph 1 of Resolution 242 of the Security Council of the United Nations from 1967, which states:

“1. Affirms that the fulfilment of Charter principles requires the establishment of a just and lasting peace in the Middle East which should include the application of both the following principles:

- (i) Withdrawal of Israel armed forces from [the] territories occupied in the recent conflict;
- (ii) Termination of all claims or states of belligerency and respect for and acknowledgement of the sovereignty, territorial integrity and political independence of every State in the area and their right to live in peace within secure and recognized boundaries free from threats or acts of force;”

34. We, ordinary people, acknowledge that United Nations Security Council Resolution 242 (S/RES/242) was adopted unanimously by the Security Council on 22 November 1967. We further affirm that, in light of this decision, the occupation by the State of Israel of Gaza, the West Bank, East Jerusalem¹⁴ and parts of Lebanon and Syria must come to an immediate end, and that the inhabitants of illegal settlements must subsequently accept disarmament, must properly return stolen land¹⁵ to its owners and must accept the rule of the Palestinian State. In any case, the ruling of the International Court of Justice of 19 July 2024 makes clear that “*the State of Israel is under an obligation to cease immediately all new settlement activities, and to evacuate all settlers from the Occupied Palestinian Territory*”. Under no circumstances should Palestinian inhabitants of their own country be forcibly relocated to other areas or countries to make way for illegal settlers.

¹⁴ East Jerusalem is an extra-sensitive issue for Jews and Palestinians alike which requires additional negotiations between the sovereign states of Israel and Palestine instead of acquisition of territory by force by the State of Israel.

¹⁵ We reject claims that refer to antiquity.

35. We note that Resolution 242 (1967) has been reaffirmed in subsequent legal acts of the United Nations Security Council, including Resolutions 338 (1973), 1392 (2002), 1515 (2003) and 2334 (2016), and that Resolution 242 was central to the agreements reached in Camp David (1978), Madrid (1991) and Oslo (1993). We, ordinary people, acknowledge that non-compliance with the instructions by the Security Council has led the State of Israel to seize property through extreme force - such as by acts of genocide -, intimidation and other forms of pressure, resulting in the unlawful expropriation of rights belonging to Palestine and its inhabitants. We further recognise that millions of people are directly and indirectly affected by the conquests carried out by the State of Israel, and that this ongoing pattern of expropriation and illegal occupations is characteristic of the conduct of a predatory state that has failed to calibrate its course on the Rule of Law – the standard for modern state craft.

Resolution 242, the need for rehousing and making new land

36. We, ordinary people, acknowledge that the rehousing of the inhabitants of illegal settlements within the internationally recognised territory of the State of Israel, as required by Resolution 242, may create housing challenges in Israel itself due to shortages of housing facilities, land, or both. We affirm that, in no circumstance may limited space within the State of Israel be invoked by any party, or the United Nations, as a justification for driving the original inhabitants from their territory as defined by Resolution 242 (1967).

37. All Palestinians, whether refugees, detainees or of the diaspora, have a right of return to their Palestinian territories that belong to the Palestinian state in line with UN resolution 242¹⁶. We, ordinary people, acknowledge that the ordinary people of Palestine and of the current State of Israel must live in a state founded on the principle of the Rule of Law. This is fundamentally different from a state that sustains itself through acts of terror; through acts which we consider to constitute acts of genocide and war crimes; through the expulsion of original inhabitants; through the constant intimidation of residents; through the killing of journalists; and through the deprivation of the population's access to food and water, to health-care facilities, to basic respect owed to all humans beings, and to the essential conditions required to maintain basic human wellbeing.

Continuous misrepresentation of facts and context

38. We, ordinary people, acknowledge that in view of the ongoing war as executed by the State of Israel reporting on the realities of life in Palestine, in Lebanon, Syria,

¹⁶ In 1948, the UN General Assembly adopted Resolution 194, affirming that Palestinian refugees wishing to return to their homes and live in peace should be permitted to do so. UN Security Council Resolution 242 (1967) affirms the inadmissibility of acquiring territory by war.

Jordan and Iran is persistently distorted. We further recognise that this distortion concerns both the needs of the populations in these regions and their actual living conditions, and that the vast volume of falsehoods – understood as the deliberate misrepresentation of facts and context – circulating via the internet and conventional media has itself become a form of oppression for the people concerned. We insist that the killing of more than 225 journalists by the State of Israel in Gaza and Lebanon since 2023 forms part of a broader effort to muzzle the media and exercise extreme repression in each individual case, conduct which amounts to a war crime. We acknowledge that curbing state-driven misinformation does not fall squarely within the formal mandate of your organisation; nevertheless, the pervasive culture of misrepresentation by direct or indirect state actors must stop. To this end, we insist that you recognise that respect for the Rule of Law is absent in the areas concerned, and that we expect the United Nations to take prompt and appropriate actions to address and remedy this serious deficiency.

Suppression of free speech unacceptable

39. We, ordinary people, acknowledge that, in addition to state-supported coercion, the State of Israel adopted in 2026 legislation referred to as the “Death Penalty for Terrorists Law”. To us the death penalty is not acceptable in any circumstance. This penalty is not compatible with core human rights, under which the right to life. This cruel and inhuman punishment is in violation with the Rule of Law which includes respect for human rights and international law. We also note that the “Death Penalty for Terrorists Law” appears to target, among others, Palestinians in the occupied territories and nationals of the State of Israel who deny the right of existence of the State of Israel. Such legislation is contrary to free speech, has an oppressive effect and is largely aimed at crushing all forms of Palestinian resistance, including non-militant resistance. The law strengthens apartheid.

No future for coercive state-action as a means for securing change of mind

40. We, ordinary people, acknowledge that there can be no credibility for the State of Israel if it seeks to change the minds or characters of people – whether as a group or as individuals – by force. This includes the imposition of detention regimes of absurd and dehumanising proportions; cultural destruction; the destruction of inhabitants’ living conditions in the occupied territories; the stealing of water sources; the infliction of lifelong physical and psychological harm; the dismantling of healthcare provision; the devastation of crops; the tearing up of roads and the destruction of other infrastructure within and between civilian communities; the suppression of public communications channels; or the use of any other means of coercion and violence in the occupied territories.

Route to peaceful normality

41. We, ordinary people, acknowledge that genuine change of mind arises through demonstrations of mutual respect, friendship and love for people, for the

environment and for the nature in which they live. We recognise that those who are active in fields of tender loving care (TLC) for others – such as in healthcare – can serve as shining examples of how to connect with people and with the sources of their inspiration. We affirm that the route to peaceful normality runs through our minds and our hearts, and that no abusive force can alter this fundamental reality. Therefore, the persecution of carers, humanitarian agents and medical personnel is to be condemned. The United Nations Relief and Works Agency for Palestine Refugees in the Near East (UNRWA) must be strengthened, financed, politically and diplomatically supported by the entire UN community, and vigorously defended.

Women to be involved in decision making

42. We, ordinary people, acknowledge that it is naïve and misguided to believe, or suggest, that massive destruction of environments, of individuals, of groups of people or, indeed, of entire centres of civilisation can bring about a meaningful change of mind. We note that men particularly hold this distorted view. We observe that men in leadership positions have publicly boasted of their capacity to destroy people, groups and other civilisations, that we regard this as shockingly immature behaviour. We further acknowledge that this destructive mindset causes immense harm in personal relationships and in societies at large, and that such men are among the leaders of states that feed and fuel the ongoing hostilities in the regions concerned. For this reason, we consider it imperative that women systematically take an impactful part in the decision-making processes regarding the matters we are asking the United Nations to address. We recall that this is consistent with United Nations Security Council Resolution 1325, adopted in 2000, which calls, inter alia, for greater participation of women in peace negotiations and conflict resolution and forms part of the broader “Women, Peace and Security” agenda. We affirm that this agenda requires immediate implementation as a mandatory commitment to the type of decisions requested herein.

No tyranny is acceptable

43. We, ordinary people, acknowledge that no coercion on the ground and no bombing campaign can be justified by any state when it involves deliberate, disproportionate or excessive force. Modern technology enables precise military targeting. We affirm that the kind of war waged by the State of Israel since October 7, 2023, characterized by total destruction, bears no relation to precision technology. We believe it to be self-evident that the continuous and overwhelming display of force through incessant and massively destructive bombing raids by the State of Israel, together with a variety of other coercive measures and operations, constitutes deliberate acts which we consider amount to acts of genocide and other war crimes. We consider this to be self-evident for any observer and that no army of lawyers can convince us of the opposite. We acknowledge that these gravely wrongful acts are directed at people in the occupied territories, at those in South Lebanon and at people in other parts of the Middle East. We consider that these abuses are so abundantly clear that it is

shameful to suggest – as numerous officials, politicians, journalists and commentators continue to do – that such atrocities merely give rise to “concern” or similar euphemisms. We affirm instead that unequivocal condemnation of these acts of state-based terror must be the standard and only appropriate response. We, ordinary people, understand this instinctively, as the state-based acts of terror carried out by the State of Israel are too brutal and horrific for words.

44. We, ordinary people, further acknowledge that the State of Israel has stated that its bombing campaign has been undertaken as a “tit for tat” strategy, and that it acts without restraint in responding to whatever it deems appropriate. We recognize that in doing so the State of Israel places itself in the position of a tyrannical state acting without restraint. The latter is a ‘no-go area’ according to international law. To be clear, principles such as those regarding distinction, proportionality and military necessity are well known factors to consider in war activities as opposed to ‘acting without restraint’ which cannot be legitimate by default.

45. We, ordinary people, denounce any tyrannical state, and not limited to states that practice systematic violence resulting in ethnic cleansing and genocide. We believe that the United Nations should do likewise, particularly in respect of a state it helped to create. We recall that peoples have, throughout history, asserted the right to reject tyrannical rule by authorities that exercise power without restraint, as evidenced by the Declaration of Independence of the United States of America (1776) and the Act of Abjuration of the Netherlands (1581). We consider that, in the present 21st century, there is no conceivable reason to support the absolute sovereignty of a tyrannical state merely because that sovereignty was once - in part – promoted and endorsed by the authority of the United Nations or allegedly was promised by the authority of God aiming at restoring an idealized past of 3000 years ago. On the contrary, we maintain that, in such tyrannical circumstances, the sovereign power of the State of Israel must be re-examined with a view to the suspension of the full membership of the State of Israel at the UN and all UN agencies, limiting it to observer status.

46. We maintain that there is no authority that can outweigh the importance of the Rule of Law and the inherent respect for international law¹⁷. In the world community we cannot continue with states which are lashing out via acts of genocide, crimes of war and other coercive measures that do not comply with the Rule of Law. That is what we, ordinary people, believe and we appeal to the

¹⁷ To be sure, deliberately derailing, uprooting or sabotaging the workings of the Rule of Law while, simultaneously, making positive references to authorities as mentioned above (being ‘the authority of the UN’ and the ‘authority of God’) or to other authorities or creeds (such as those related to making money or finance in general), claiming that instructions, rulings or statements by these authorities override the Rule of Law, are misguided. The observations about those authorities or creeds on financial gains have far fewer good cards than about those who insist on the regular use of the Rule of Law. The meaningful application of the Rule of Law enhances the well-being of citizens, including the legal certainty that people generally long for. In addition, the application of the Rule of Law curbs extremism, discourages violence (especially state-violence) and, by default, supports solutions that are built on fair play.

United Nations to put a hold on this. This request is irrespective of which political party or coalition of political parties is or can be in power in the State of Israel. Instead, it is related to the policy of the government in charge at any given period.

Time aspects and time to act

47. Regarding the multifold forms of violence commissioned on the people of the State of Palestine by the State of Israel we note that we are aware of approaching Legislative Israeli elections in October 2026. Some believe that their outcome will influence whether the Israeli government's current destructive policies towards the occupied Palestinian territories and the Palestinian people are continued, prolonged in other forms or brought to an immediate end¹⁸. Whatever the outcome of these Legislative elections, the total destruction of Gaza as a living space and of other areas in the Middle East through the committed genocide and other acts of extreme state violence during the last three years (October 2023 – August 2026) by the State of Israel can clearly not be undone for generations to come. A credible public display of accountability for this expression of utter state failure¹⁹ is a must towards the Palestinian people and to the world community as it stands united in the United Nations. We, ordinary people, believe that the United Nations should lead the way in this process by providing indications on how to overcome the obliteration of Palestinian territory and the indescribable hurt the State of Israel has committed towards the Palestinian people in its war against the Hamas organisation. To be clear, this view about the perceived role of the United Nations does not intend to mitigate in any way the immense pain and damage the committed crimes that Hamas has caused on 7 October 2023, but, as stated before, this Appeal addresses the behaviour of a state that is member of the United Nations, not a group nor any individual.

48. The Israeli electorate will understand that the outcome of the forthcoming national election in Israel can influence the way the United Nations, individual countries or individuals can be helpful in finding a road to healing. The electorate can therefore make a difference. At the same time, however, the present situation requires action by the United Nations. Our demand to the United Nations is, as we have listed in our Request (see below), to alter the member-status of the State of Israel in the United Nations into observer status, meaning denying the State of Israel the rights to vote and to propose resolutions in the United Nations. Be it otherwise, we then face the point that on the one hand the State of Israel—being partly the result of an initiative of the United Nations—has committed and is committing acts of genocide and other criminal acts that run counter to the UN Charter while, at the same time, it is influencing the future of this world as a participant in the voting rounds of the United Nations. We, ordinary people, believe such is an undefendable combination in the face of the world and that the State of Israel, which perpetrates the 'crime of crimes', must on the contrary

¹⁸ Most Israeli political parties either support in 2026 continued Israeli control over territories occupied in 1967, or they do not advocate an end to the occupation. The clearest opposition to the occupation comes from parties in which Palestinian citizens of Israel have a dominant voice.

¹⁹ Genocide is in this Appeal regarded as a form of utter state failure by the country that commits such a crime.

be corrected by the UN, and this in immediate terms by resetting its formal status of 'member' of the United Nations into that of 'observer'.

49. As from the moment leading Israeli representatives publicly indicated that the State of Israel would respond with genocidal intent on the heinous attack by Hamas on 7 October 2023, we, ordinary people, have been waiting for an immediate response of the world community on that genocidal approach. The Israeli statement "There will be no electricity and no water. There will only be destruction (...)" said it all. Genocide was oncoming as the 'no water'-expression equals to: 'no life'. However, the response by Western countries to this ominous statement of 9 October 2023 was lukewarm, marking at the same time the manifest moral downfall of, at least, the so-called Western countries. Now, nearly three years on, experts on genocide agree that the factual response of Israel has indeed been no less than genocide and that the denial of this 'crime of crimes' bears no ground. Even the continued murders of a great many journalists who reported about the dire situation in the occupied territories cannot conceal this horrific fact.
50. In addition, we note that the International Court of Justice has meanwhile ruled on 19 July 2024 about the occupied territories, stating that the occupation of these territories is illegal; that a resolution of the General Assembly about this court ruling has put the State of Israel on a timeframe to withdraw from the occupied territories which it does not; that the in many ways beleaguered 'UN Special Rapporteur on the occupied Palestinian territories', Francesca Albanese, has reported in March 2024 about the Gaza war and stated 'reasonable grounds' to believe that acts of genocide have been committed by the State of Israel; that other reports by international organizations have been published about the same topic; and that the genocide continues.
51. Against the backdrop of all the above we, ordinary people, ask the United Nations to act as we request her to do (see below) and to act now. Genocide, committed by an UN-enabled state, demands immediate attention and corrective action. Act without delay!

Right and obligation to halt acts of terror

52. We, ordinary people, acknowledge that every state has both the right and the obligation to halt acts of terror within its borders, regardless of whether such acts are perpetrated by individuals, by groups or by terrorist organisations. We affirm that this obligation is a given for any state that respects the Rule of Law. We further acknowledge that this right and obligation to counter terrorism does not include any right for a state to act as a terrorist organisation in turn, meaning 'tit for tat'. We maintain that measures to halt acts of terror must be taken in accordance with disciplined protocols that are consistent with the Rule of Law. We affirm that the Rule of Law is absent in the State of Israel in relation to the way it exercises control over the illegally occupied territories and in relation to the war it has waged since October 2023.

Equality before the law and no discrimination

53. We, ordinary people, acknowledge that, in a state that respects the Rule of Law, there can be no first-, second- or third-class people. Yet Israel practices apartheid. The application of the Rule of Law requires that everyone be treated as equal before the law and that discrimination against individuals or groups be rejected as a matter of principle. We affirm that the State of Israel is not the exclusive preserve of any group, and that it must respect all people within and beyond its borders.
54. We, ordinary people, maintain that heinous and ongoing evidence to the contrary as outlined above disqualifies the State of Israel from remaining a full member of the United Nations. Consequently, we insist that the General Assembly of the United Nations has an obligation to - at a minimum - suspend the membership of the State of Israel to the United Nations and its agencies, reducing it to observer status. It is neither conceivable, understandable nor acceptable to us, ordinary people, that such a state should remain unchallenged in its membership of the United Nations while acting in direct opposition to the purpose of the United Nations.

Best effort to uphold standards

55. We, ordinary people, call on all member-states of the United Nations to respond to this Appeal in an affirmative manner. The international community must hold to a basic standard by denouncing acts of genocide and war crimes, - notwithstanding that any member-state has to raise its own performance with respect to upholding the Rule of Law.

Israeli coercion is not a struggle on behalf of Western civilisation

56. We, ordinary people, acknowledge that it has been claimed that the atrocities carried out by the State of Israel in the regions concerned should be regarded as an effort to defend Western civilisation. We consider such a claim to be preposterous, and we hold that this claim must be rejected wherever it is advanced. We note that many countries commonly regarded as part of “Western civilisation” strive to anchor their public administrations in the principle of the Rule of Law. We recognise that the understanding of Rule of Law as the key organising principle for public administration has emerged only after tumultuous and violent histories spanning many centuries. We maintain that to suggest that the atrocities committed by the State of Israel are undertaken in defence of Western civilisation is bitter nonsense. Western states and many other states endeavour to distance themselves from coercive regimes; by contrast, the viable way forward for modern states is to rely on a reasonable body of law and on the wisdom required to apply that law in a reasonable manner, both nationally and internationally.

57. We, ordinary people, call on the United Nations to take immediate action in relation to the matters addressed in this Appeal, and to undertake, without delay, a resettling of its own approach so as to abandon any apparent policy of leniency or indulgence towards a state that brutalizes people under its rule and engages in acts which we consider to constitute acts of genocide and war crimes against people beyond the borders of the State of Israel (1949 -1967).

58. We, ordinary people, request the United Nations in sum:

1. To suspend the full membership of the State of Israel at the UN and in all UN agencies, limiting it to observer status²⁰;
2. to compel Israel to withdraw from the occupied territories (in accordance, among others, with UN Security Council Resolution 242, the ruling of the International Court of Justice of 19 July 2024 and the UN General Assembly Resolution 194);
3. To act in such a manner that the State of Israel respects the Rule of Law;
4. To reinvent the United Nations itself in such a manner that its agencies are protected, that Human Rights are defended, that the General Assembly can act promptly and collectively in the case of genocide and war crimes, if necessary, circumventing the Security Council;
5. To systematically involve women in a meaningful way in the decision-making processes and agencies.

59. In view of the above we, ordinary people, furthermore request that the UN undertakes to activate the international community to become a corrective force for Israel to reform itself, by isolating Israel and its complicit allies through cessation of trade with parties that have ties with the Israeli government, by applying selectivity in cultural exchange and international travel in view of acts of genocide, crimes of war, violations of human rights and infringement of civic freedoms.

Signed by order and on behalf of ordinary people,

REYNIER OVERHOFF, a representative of ordinary people.

²⁰ It is proactively understood that the observer-status, as requested under 1, may shift back to full-member status depending on the moment when the State of Israel meets the standard of the Rule of Law, including adherence to international law. The Charter mentions suspension (art. 5) and expulsion (art. 6). We believe that the UN should nonetheless act as requested in the light of extreme violations of the Rule of Law and reduce the position of the State of Israel to observer status.